

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 3
♥ Q 9 6
♦ K 9 8 7 5
♣ 7 6

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J



♠ -

♥ A 5 4 3 2

♦ Q J T 4

♣ T 5 4 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J T 7

♦ -

♣ A 9 8 3

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			

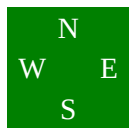
Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 5 2
 ♥ 2
 ♦ T 8 6 5 4
 ♣ A 7 4 2

♠ A T 8
 ♥ K 9 8 4
 ♦ K 9
 ♣ K T 6 5



♠ 9 7 4 3
 ♥ Q J 5 3
 ♦ 7 3 2
 ♣ 8 3

♠ K Q J
 ♥ A T 7 6
 ♦ A Q J
 ♣ Q J 9

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
All Pass			
5♥ by South			

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 5 4 3 2

♥ 3

♦ 9 8 6 2

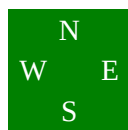
♣ J 7 2

♠ 7

♥ K Q 9 8 5

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ 9 8 3



♠ T 8 6

♥ 6 4 2

♦ J T 3

♣ A 6 5 4

♠ A K Q J

♥ A J T 7

♦ A 5

♣ K Q T

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, so you bid 5♣. Partner bids the ♥ slam.

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♣

Pass

5♣

Pass

4NT

All Pass

6♥

6♥ by North

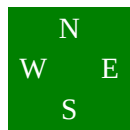
Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 2
 ♥ J 7 3
 ♦ J T 6 5
 ♣ A 7 4 3

♠ K T
 ♥ A K 9 8 4
 ♦ K Q 8
 ♣ K Q 6



♠ 8 6 4
 ♥ Q T 2
 ♦ 9 7 2
 ♣ J T 9 5

♠ A Q J 7 5 3
 ♥ 6 5
 ♦ A 4 3
 ♣ 8 2

The bidding has been as shown.

Your partner has shown a minimum opening hand, but with 6 ♠s. You are happy with the 8-card trump fit but need to know about Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5 ♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner has two Aces and the ♠Q. That should be all he needs to make slam so you bid 6 ♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♠
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 9 5 3
♥ 2
♦ 6 5 2
♣ K Q J 9 3

♠ 7 6 4 2
♥ K J 9 8 5
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ -



♠ 8
♥ 7 6
♦ T 9 3
♣ A T 8 6 5 4 2

♠ A K Q J
♥ A Q T 4 3
♦ A J 8
♣ 7

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, but you also have a void in ♣s. You therefore answer 6♣. Partner goes all the way to 7♥.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♣	Pass	7♥
All Pass			
7♥ by North			

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

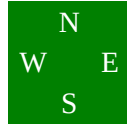
♠ 4
 ♥ 8 6 5
 ♦ A 9 7 4
 ♣ 9 6 5 4 3

♠ K 6 5 2

♥ A Q 7 4

♦ K 8 6

♣ A Q



♠ A T 9 7

♥ K J T

♦ Q J T 3

♣ K J

♠ Q J 8 3

♥ 9 3 2

♦ 5 2

♣ T 8 7 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♠
All Pass			
5♠ by South			

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has 15-17 points and 4 ♠s. You have 18 points and 4 ♠s. You plan to bid the slam, but first you check Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner says 5♣.

You are missing 1 Key-Card. Slam has become less certain. You decide to see if partner has the trump Queen so you bid 5♦. Partner bids 5♠. What do you say next?

Partner denies having the ♠Q. Knowing that the best you could hope for would be a finesse to make the slam you give up your quest and pass.